INSTITUTE OF
ECONOMIC GROWTH
Estd. 1952

5th Kautilya Economic Conclave

NEW DELHI | 2026

सत्यमेव जयते
Ministry of Finance
Government of India

N.K. Singh
President, Board of Trustees, IEG
Chairman, 15th Finance Commission

16 July 2026

5th Kautilya Economic Conclave, 2026 : New Delhi

Dear Dr Karazhan,

It is with great pleasure that I invite you to the Fifth **Kautilya Economic Conclave (KEC)**, being held in New Delhi from **3-5 October 2026**. The KEC returns after four successful editions, organised by the Institute of Economic Growth, in partnership with the Ministry of Finance. The Conclave is designed to foster policy dialogue between domain experts on contemporary economic and social challenges.

The themes of the conference have evolved in tandem with changing global challenges: from **Redefining the Future** (2022) and **Navigating a World on Fire** (2023), to witnessing the dawn of **The Indian Era** (2024) and **Seeking Prosperity in Turbulent Times** (2025). A background note on the KEC from its inception is also enclosed.

As we approach the **Fifth Edition**, the international system appears to be entering a phase of profound transition, marked by rising geopolitical tensions, economic uncertainty, and prolonged strategic ambiguity that may intensify in the months ahead. At the recent Raisina Dialogue, Finland's President Alexander Stubb suggested the world may be approaching **a New Bretton Woods moment**, in which India and the wider Global South will increasingly shape the next phase of the international order. India's trajectory toward **Viksit Bharat 2047**, promising **FTA frameworks with the EU and the US**, and initiatives such as the **India AI Impact Summit** highlight both its growing role and the broader global dilemma between technological sovereignty and global governance. Against this backdrop, the Conclave will also examine the **urbanisation challenge across Asia and Africa**, including mounting **air and water pollution**; the implications of **mental health pressures**, **social media**, and rising screen time for the realisation of the **demographic dividend**; whether further gains remain in agricultural productivity alongside the urgent task of **climate-proofing agriculture** through global experience-sharing.

It is in this context that the **2026 Theme** will reflect the evolving **contours of Global Power and Trade**, **Disruption of the Multilateral System**, the acceleration of **AI amid Regulatory Competition**, and the **growing Strategic and Economic Interdependence between Asia and Africa**. Discussions will also reflect **the Future of Labour Markets in an era of Technological Disruption**, alongside the Emergence of **Shifting Paradigms of Development.**

This Conference has fostered candid exchange between leading scholars, policymakers, and stakeholders over a wide spectrum. Given your domain expertise, your participation would greatly enrich our discussions and contribute to the Conclave's continuing role as a bridge between economic thinking and social thinking to shape policy choices. We would be delighted to have you join us in New Delhi for this year's edition of the Kautilya Economic Conclave.

The organizers would fully bear any logistical costs during your stay in Delhi, including providing business class air travel. We would be happy to answer any questions or concerns to facilitate your participation. A more granular agenda will follow closer to the date, even as we will watch closely for unfolding events. We greatly look forward to your support and participation.

With Best Wishes,

Yours sincerely,

(N K Singh)

Dr Yerlik Karazhan
Chief Executive Officer
Central Asia Climate Foundation
Astana
Kazakhstan

Tel. :91-11-27667260, 9810322376, 9810334376 (Direct)
EPABX : 9910322376, 27666364, 27667288, 27667365
Email: nandu@nksingh.com, nksingh@nksingh.com
Website: http://www.iegindia.org